

Leandro's "Let's Make a Trading Card Game" (parts 1-28): key points for Dark Charterlands

Leandro's 28-part video diary (2014-2018) of designing and launching his own trading card game, Multiverse: mechanics, playtesting, complexity, card wording, art, the online beta, and a Kickstarter launch with lessons learned.

28 of 28 videos processed. The local Mistral pipeline extracted timestamped points from captions; parts 1 and 10 used local Whisper transcripts. The design lens generated the *For us* implications. Design areas were filed from each point's own text; ten files were manually reviewed after the Claude session stopped. These are research prompts, not adopted mechanics.

How to read this: Verify consequential claims against the linked video moment. Summaries and implications are model output. Manual filing changes organization, not factual status. Some suggestions conflict with the current design (such as random events or extra Seasons).

Regenerate: `python apply_lens.py --set leandro --digest-only`, then `python build_pdf.py --set leandro`.

Headline lesson per video

Video	Views	Lesson
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 1 (Leandro)	27,577	The most important lesson from this video is the importance of balance and intuitive card design in creating a engaging and strategic trading card game.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 2 (Leandro)	7,442	The team should focus on creating clear roles and identities for cards, distributing card types thoughtfully, and considering unique elements to enhance the game's strategic depth and pacing.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 3 (Leandro)	8,173	The most important lesson for the team is to focus on balancing cards based on their impact and resource costs, considering the value of having cards in hand and the additional reward for waiting extra turns to play higher-cost cards.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 4 (Leandro)	5,718	The most important lesson from this video is the significance of balancing game mechanics through mathematical models and designing for multiple player configurations to ensure a fair and engaging experience for all players.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 5 (Leandro)	5,730	The most important lesson from this video is the significance of thorough playtesting and the design of versatile, simple common cards to ensure a balanced and engaging gameplay experience.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 6 (Leandro)	5,345	The most important lesson from this video is the importance of iterative playtesting and balancing, especially when introducing new mechanics or factions, to ensure a smooth and engaging gameplay experience.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 7 (Leandro)	3,458	Simplify complex mechanics for new players and ensure decks encourage strategic variety through balanced high-end cards.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 8 (Leandro)	2,500	Balancing cards and creating a diverse set of strategies are crucial for a successful draft format in a trading card game.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 9 (Leandro)	2,439	The most important lesson from this video is the significance of playtesting and balancing unique mechanics and strategies to ensure a well-rounded and engaging gameplay experience.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 10 (Leandro)	2,350	It is crucial to test and iterate on game design based on real play experiences, especially when it comes to pacing and luck, to ensure a balanced and engaging experience for all players.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 11 (Leandro)	3,217	The team should be prepared to iterate on gameplay mechanics based on playtesting feedback, especially if certain strategies become too dominant.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 12 (Leandro)	1,886	The most important lesson from this video is the significance of iterative design and playtesting in creating a balanced and engaging trading card game, particularly in refining resource systems and strategic dynamics.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 13 (Leandro)	1,886	The most important lesson from this video is the importance of iterative design and playtesting to refine game mechanics and ensure a smooth and engaging player experience, particularly in multiplayer settings.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 14 (Leandro)	1,436	The most important lesson from this video is the significance of thorough balancing and iterative design, along with the importance of high-quality, thematic artwork in enhancing player experience.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 15 (Leandro)	2,777	Thorough playtesting and iterative design are crucial for balancing and refining the game's mechanics and strategies.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 16 (Leandro)	1,860	The most important lesson from this video is the significance of community involvement and iterative design in shaping a trading card game's dynamics and balance.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 17 (Leandro)	1,319	Conduct thorough internal testing to identify and address balance issues before wider playtesting.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 18 (Leandro)	1,539	The most important lesson from this video is the importance of iterative development and player feedback in shaping the game's mechanics, balance, and overall player experience.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 19 (Leandro)	1,459	The most important lesson from this video is the significance of testing and balancing new mechanics to ensure they enhance gameplay without disrupting the desired pace, especially in a multiplayer format.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 20 (Leandro)	1,091	Organized play-testing and community feedback are crucial for balancing and refining the game, especially for a physical card game focused on booster drafts and multiplayer formats.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 21 (Leandro)	1,600	The most important lesson from this video is the need to balance and diversify gameplay mechanics and card effects to cater to various player types and ensure a rich, engaging experience.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 22 (Leandro)	1,366	Streamline mechanics and consider player experience to enhance gameplay and accessibility.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game 23: Launch of the Multiverse Online Beta! (Leandro)	842	Adapting abilities to add depth and strategic choices can enhance gameplay, so consider how similar mechanics can be integrated into Dark Charterlands.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game 24: Complexity in TCGs (Leandro)	1,047	To make Dark Charterlands more accessible, the team should focus on simplifying the onboarding process through tutorials, preconstructed decks, and a base set with simpler cards, while ensuring the game remains strategically deep.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game 25: Finding the right platform (Leandro)	667	The most important lesson for the team is to focus on creating a clear and intuitive user interface for the physical components of the game, ensuring that players can easily understand and navigate the game.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 26 - Kickstarter Launch, Multiplayer & Card Wordings (Leandro)	907	The most important lesson from this video is the critical need for clear, unambiguous card wording and intuitive terminology to enhance player understanding and engagement, especially in a complex, multiplayer trading card game.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 27 - Card Art Creation Process & Card Front Design (Leandro)	4,584	The most important lesson from this video is the importance of clear, intuitive design for an enhanced user experience, which will help new players understand the game and make informed decisions.
Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 28 - Kickstarter Lessons Learned & New Card Front (Leandro)	1,305	The most important lesson from this video is the value of learning from failure and iterating on design based on real-world feedback and constraints, particularly in areas like card layout, costing, and balance.

Takeaways by design area

Sorted by relevance (high first). Low-relevance takeaways appear only per video.

Draft & set structure

- **The speaker is working on making the basic set of their trading card game draftable, involving multiple strategies and balanced cards.** (high). [Leandro, 0:11](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that each of the 10 two-faction draft archetypes in Dark Charterlands has similar support and is balanced. Reuse interesting cards from previous sets or other games to maintain consistency. This will help in creating a diverse and strategic draft experience.
- **Significant changes have been made to the card set for 'Multiverse Cosmic Conquest'.** (high). [Leandro, 6:37](#)
 - *For us:* Consider the distribution of uncommon cards and their impact on limited gameplay and booster drafts. Ensure that each faction has a balanced number of uncommon cards to maintain fairness and strategic depth in drafts.
- **The speaker decided to transition the game from a trading card format to a living card game format.** (high). [Leandro, 25:41](#)
 - *For us:* Consider the implications of the game's format on card design and balance. Ensure that the cards are designed to work well together in the multiplayer free-for-all format, and that the game's balance is not overly reliant on rarities or draft environments.
- **The creator discusses the structure and design process of the game, including the distribution of card types and colors.** (medium). [Leandro, 2:05](#)
 - *For us:* Distribute card types in Dark Charterlands thoughtfully, considering the balance between different types of cards (e.g., units, structures, abilities) and their roles in the game. This will help in creating clear strategies and maintaining a balanced gameplay experience.
- **The game features different formats of play, including constructed and limited, with the speaker preferring limited formats.** (medium). [Leandro, 16:39](#)
 - *For us:* Consider focusing on limited formats for playtesting and tournaments, as they are generally fairer and provide a more level playing field. This will help ensure that the game is balanced and enjoyable for all players, regardless of their collection size.
- **The speaker discusses the process of creating booster packs and the rarity of cards within them.** (medium). [Leandro, 2:42](#)

- *For us:* Design booster packs with a clear rarity distribution to maintain balance and excitement. Ensure that each pack contains a mix of Commons, Uncommons, Rares, and unique cards to keep the draft experience engaging.
- **The game set consists of 200 Arsenal cards and 14 Galaxy cards, with a specific rarity distribution to balance the game.** (medium). [Leandro, 0:32](#)
 - *For us:* The team should consider a similar rarity distribution for Dark Charterlands to ensure that the probability of drawing specific cards aligns with their rarity and power level. This will help maintain gameplay balance, especially since booster draft is the primary way to play. The team should also consider how the rarity distribution affects the drafting experience and the overall meta.
- **The speaker discusses the enjoyment and challenges of deck building in trading card games, emphasizing the fun of creating unique and wacky decks.** (medium). [Leandro, 12:28](#)
 - *For us:* Include cards in Dark Charterlands that inspire unique and wacky deck-building experiences. This will add fun and unpredictability to the game, even if some decks are not highly effective.
- **The speaker is making changes to the card game Multiverse, including adjusting the number of cards per color and adding a new rare card.** (medium). [Leandro, 29:10](#)
 - *For us:* Be prepared to make adjustments to the card set as needed. Consider the implications of adding or removing cards on the game's balance and overall design.

Multiplayer & politics

- **The game 'Mothership' supports multiple player configurations, including two, three, four, and six players.** (high). [Leandro, 0:41](#)
 - *For us:* Consider designing specific boards or 'galaxies' for different player counts, such as 3 or 4 players, to optimize the multiplayer experience. Ensure that the game's mechanics scale well with the number of players, and avoid configurations that are not typically recommended, such as five players.
- **The 3-player draft game was too long and highlighted issues with galaxy size and ship movement.** (high). [Leandro, 4:05](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that the game's core loop is designed to be completed in a reasonable amount of time, especially for the multiplayer free-for-all format. Consider adjusting the size of the game area (the map) and the movement speed of units to facilitate quicker engagement and resolution of conflicts. This will help keep games within the 20-40 minute target.
- **The game includes multiplayer features with instant actions to enhance interaction and reduce wait times.** (high). [Leandro, 1:31](#)
 - *For us:* Introduce 'instant actions' to allow players to respond to actions directly affecting them, reducing wait times and increasing interaction. This is especially important in multiplayer games where turn-based mechanics can lead to longer game durations.
- **The 'wormhole' card is introduced to make multiplayer games more dynamic and engaging.** (medium). [Leandro, 8:23](#)
 - *For us:* Design cards like the 'wormhole' card to enhance interaction and dynamics in multiplayer games. Ensure these cards are balanced and do not overpower two-player games.

Resource system

- **The resource system of the game has evolved significantly, moving from a literal interpretation of resources to a more thematic and strategic approach.** (high). [Leandro, 6:25](#)

- *For us:* The team should ensure that the resource system in Dark Charterlands is not only thematic but also strategically diverse. This means having resources that encourage different playstyles and strategies, similar to how Multiverse evolved its resource system. The team should test various resource configurations to see which ones create the most engaging and varied gameplay experiences.
- **The video outlines the resource system and color-based strategies in 'The Mothership'** (medium). [Leandro, 5:12](#)
 - *For us:* Consider a color-based strategy system for Dark Charterlands, where each faction has unique characteristics and strategies. This could add depth to the game and encourage diverse deck-building approaches.
- **The speaker discovered that the balance between creatures and ships in Multiverse adds an element of luck to the game.** (medium). [Leandro, 7:55](#)
 - *For us:* Be mindful of the balance between different types of cards (units, Edicts, Holdings, Relics) and how they interact with the resource system (Seals). Ensure that the game does not become overly reliant on luck, which could frustrate experienced players. Consider testing different deck compositions to identify any potential issues with luck and balance.
- **The speaker rethought the color system of the game Multiverse, leading to a new six-color resource system.** (medium). [Leandro, 13:33](#)
 - *For us:* The team should carefully design the faction dynamics in Dark Charterlands to ensure each faction has a clear identity and strategic role. This includes considering how different factions interact with each other and how their unique abilities contribute to the overall gameplay experience. The team should also ensure that the color system, if implemented, is distinct and meaningful.

Costing & balance

- **The host introduces a formula to balance the cards based on their impact and resource cost.** (high). [Leandro, 2:45](#)
 - *For us:* The team should develop a formula to balance cards based on their impact and resource cost. This formula should consider the value of having a card in hand and the additional reward for waiting an extra turn to play a higher-cost card. This will help ensure that cards are balanced and that their costs are appropriate for their effects.
- **The host discusses the concept of 'impact' and how it relates to resource costs and game turns.** (high). [Leandro, 10:45](#)
 - *For us:* The team should consider the impact of cards in relation to their resource costs and the number of turns it takes to play them. This means evaluating the overall effect of a card, not just its individual stats. Cards with higher resource costs should provide a greater reward to justify waiting additional turns.
- **The creator has developed a cost impact curve to balance the game's mechanics.** (high). [Leandro, 1:25](#)
 - *For us:* Develop a cost impact curve to balance the game's resources and impacts. This will help ensure that the game is balanced and fair for all players. Consider using a mathematical model where the impact increases non-linearly with the cost, such as 1.6 impacts for two resources.
- **The first test session of the trading card game 'Mothership' was successful, but balance issues were identified among different colors.** (high). [Leandro, 0:26](#)

- *For us:* The team should carefully balance the factions (colors) in Dark Charterlands, ensuring that no faction is overpowered or underpowered. Pay special attention to the power level of individual cards, especially those with unique or powerful abilities. Consider the strategies players might employ with each faction and adjust accordingly.
- **The creator discovered that players tended to use a straightforward strategy due to the lack of high-end cards and coherent strategies in the decks.** (high). [Leandro, 4:23](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that decks have a variety of high-end cards and coherent strategies to encourage more strategic play. Test decks to make sure they incentivize different approaches beyond straightforward attacks.
- **The creator has updated the game's rules and completed the base set of cards.** (high). [Leandro, 0:56](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that the balancing algorithm for creatures and structures is robust and tested thoroughly. Consider implementing a similar algorithm for balancing units and abilities in Dark Charterlands. Additionally, plan for extensive playtesting to fine-tune the balance of cards.
- **The new rules aim to make the expansive strategy viable and add inevitability to games.** (high). [Leandro, 8:50](#)
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that the costs of actions in Dark Charterlands are balanced to avoid games becoming too fast or slow. This includes reviewing the costs of cards and abilities, especially those related to the COMMIT and CONTEST phases, to maintain a healthy pace of gameplay.
- **The power curve has been adjusted to encourage earlier gameplay and exploration.** (high). [Leandro, 0:11](#)
 - *For us:* The team should consider adjusting the power curve to encourage earlier gameplay and exploration. This could involve reducing the cost of higher-influence cards and increasing the initial hand size to make it more worthwhile to play cards earlier in the game. This will help to align with the 20-40 minute game length expectation.
- **The speaker has been refining the effects and strategies of each color in the trading card game to ensure balanced and diverse gameplay.** (high). [Leandro, 0:20](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure each faction in Dark Charterlands has a distinct identity and philosophy, with a wide range of abilities to avoid similar cards. This will help maintain balanced and diverse gameplay. Check that each faction's cards have unique effects that align with their identity.
- **The speaker has created detailed documents to organize and balance the effects and strategies of different colors.** (high). [Leandro, 3:44](#)
 - *For us:* Create detailed documents outlining the abilities and strategies for each faction and their combinations. This will help in organizing and balancing the effects and strategies of different factions in Dark Charterlands.
- **The host and guest discuss different strategies in the game, such as aggressive and defensive strategies, and how they affect the impact of cards.** (medium). [Leandro, 11:27](#)
 - *For us:* The team should design cards with different strategies in mind, understanding that aggressive and defensive strategies will affect the impact of cards differently over the course of the game. This means creating cards that are effective in various strategies and at different stages of the game.
- **Initial testing of the new rules shows promising results but also reveals balance issues.** (medium). [Leandro, 10:36](#)

- *For us:* The team should design the game to promote dynamic gameplay and inevitability, ensuring that each game has a clear winner after a certain amount of time. This can be achieved by balancing the strategies available to players and ensuring that stalemates are rare.

Turn structure & pacing

- **The speaker is working on improving the game mechanics to prevent stalling and stalemates, particularly in multiplayer games and mirror matches.** (high). [Leandro, 3:26](#)
 - *For us:* The team should identify potential causes of stalling and stalemates in Dark Charterlands, particularly in multiplayer games. They should consider adding high-impact cards that can significantly alter the game state and provide alternative win conditions to keep games dynamic and engaging.
- **The game's length needs to be balanced, as previous iterations had games that were too long, while the current version has games that are too short.** (high). [Leandro, 13:12](#)
 - *For us:* Balance the game's length to ensure matches are engaging but not overly long. Aim for the 20-40 minute range by adjusting the complexity of strategies and the power level of cards. Consider the pacing of the core loop to maintain player engagement.
- **The game's quick actions need to be balanced to avoid slowing down gameplay.** (high). [Leandro, 13:02](#)
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that any new mechanics, like quick actions, are balanced to avoid slowing down gameplay. This is particularly important in Dark Charterlands, where games are expected to take 20-40 minutes. Testing these mechanics in the multiplayer free-for-all format is crucial to maintain the desired pace.
- **The game's objective is to destroy all creatures on the opponent's planet and place your own creature there to win.** (medium). [Leandro, 12:37](#)
 - *For us:* Design a turn-based structure with distinct phases, such as beginning, main, battle, and ending. Ensure that the main phase is where most actions, including attacks, occur, and that the battle phase is triggered when an attack is initiated. This will create a clear and engaging gameplay experience.

Card & mechanic design

- **The speaker explains the top-down approach to card design, starting with a concept and then fitting it into the game.** (high). [Leandro, 16:22](#)
 - *For us:* Use a top-down approach for designing unique and intuitive cards in Dark Charterlands. Start with a concept that fits the game's lore and then create mechanics around it. This will help ensure that cards feel natural and fit well within the game.
- **The creator has completed designing the common cards for the trading card game, emphasizing their simplicity and versatility.** (high). [Leandro, 0:44](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that the common cards in Dark Charterlands are designed to be simple and versatile, so they can be used in a variety of situations. This will help maintain balance and ensure that players have useful options regardless of their draft. Avoid making common cards too situational or narrow in their effects.
- **The game features 10 monocolored strategies and 6 two-colored strategies, each with unique mechanics and races.** (high). [Leandro, 1:39](#)

- *For us:* The team should design each faction and two-faction archetype in Dark Charterlands with unique mechanics and playstyles, similar to the color strategies in the video. This will provide players with distinct choices and strategies during the draft and gameplay. The team should also consider how these archetypes interact with each other and the overall game balance.
- **The game introduces multiple strategic dynamics, including aggressive vs. defensive play, direct vs. expansive strategies, and attacking with creatures vs. attacking with ships.** (high). [Leandro, 4:09](#)
 - *For us:* Dark Charterlands should incorporate multiple strategic dynamics to keep the game engaging. This includes considering aggressive vs. defensive playstyles, direct vs. expansive strategies, and different types of attacks. The team should design mechanics that allow for these dynamics, ensuring that players have meaningful choices throughout the game.
- **The creator has been working on creating a diverse and interactive set of cards for the trading card game Multiverse.** (high). [Leandro, 0:26](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that each card in Dark Charterlands has a unique role and interaction to maintain strategic depth. Avoid making cards too similar to prevent redundancy. Focus on creating distinct strategies for each faction and two-faction archetype.
- **The speaker introduces the concept of 'reactions' to add tension to gameplay.** (high). [Leandro, 17:46](#)
 - *For us:* Introduce 'reactions' in Dark Charterlands to add tension and surprise to gameplay. Ensure that these reactions are balanced and do not disrupt the flow of the game, especially in multiplayer settings.
- **The design of the card front was redesigned to address printing issues and maximize space.** (high). [Leandro, 12:07](#)
 - *For us:* Consider the financial constraints and market realities when designing Dark Charterlands. Ensure that the game's pricing and distribution model is feasible for a smaller, independent trading card game.
- **The video provides a behind-the-scenes look at the card creation process** (medium). [Leandro, 11:47](#)
 - *For us:* Keep the initial card pool and rules simple to ease players into the game. As players become more familiar with the game, gradually introduce more complex cards and mechanics.
- **The speaker describes the bottom-up approach to card design, starting with a desired effect and then creating a concept around it.** (medium). [Leandro, 16:34](#)
 - *For us:* Consider using a bottom-up approach for designing specific effects or abilities in Dark Charterlands. This can help create powerful and unique cards that fit specific strategic needs.
- **The creator outlines the initial list of cards and their roles in the game.** (medium). [Leandro, 0:10](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that each card in Dark Charterlands has a clear role and identity, similar to the roles outlined for the space adventure game. This will help in balancing the game and providing clear strategies for players. Consider the rarity of cards and their roles in the game, such as Commons, Uncommons, and Rares, to maintain a balanced and engaging gameplay experience.
- **The creator introduces new keywords for battling mechanics, including 'First Strike', 'Range', and 'Shields'.** (medium). [Leandro, 1:45](#)

- *For us:* Consider introducing keywords or mechanics that add depth to the combat and strategy in Dark Charterlands. Keywords like 'First Strike', 'Range', and 'Shields' can create interesting dynamics and vary the gameplay, making it more engaging. Think about how these or similar mechanics can be integrated into the COMMIT and CONTEST phases.
- **Specific rules and card abilities were identified as problematic and will be adjusted for future test sessions.** (medium). [Leandro, 1:32](#)
 - *For us:* Review the rules and card abilities in Dark Charterlands to ensure they do not slow down the game or are impractical. Consider the flow of the game and how different abilities interact with the core loop. Make sure that abilities are relevant and impactful within the context of the game's turn structure.
- **The speaker is collaborating with an artist to create card art, including a toxic planet and a mountainous planet, with iterative feedback to improve the designs.** (medium). [Leandro, 0:26](#)
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that the card art in Dark Charterlands is clear and visually appealing, with iterative feedback from both the design team and playtesters to improve the designs. This will help players understand the game's themes and mechanics more easily.
- **The speaker is redesigning the color symbols for the game's cards to better represent the themes of each color.** (medium). [Leandro, 9:10](#)
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that the symbols used on cards in Dark Charterlands are intuitive and representative of the themes of each faction. This will help players quickly understand the purpose and function of each card.
- **The creator discusses the artwork for various planets, highlighting the differences and improvements made.** (medium). [Leandro, 4:03](#)
 - *For us:* Pay attention to the visual design of cards and ensure that the artwork effectively communicates the theme and mechanics of the game. Consider how the artwork can help players understand the game's lore and mechanics more intuitively.
- **The speaker is considering reintroducing instantaneous effects to the game Multiverse to enhance player interaction and gameplay dynamics.** (medium). [Leandro, 15:46](#)
 - *For us:* The team should consider introducing instantaneous effects to enhance player interaction and gameplay dynamics. However, they should be mindful of the potential complexity and pacing issues that these effects might introduce, and ensure that any changes made do not compromise the fun and fast-paced nature of the game.
- **The speaker is testing new 'quick action' cards to add elements of surprise and bluffing to the game.** (medium). [Leandro, 6:49](#)
 - *For us:* The team should consider adding 'quick actions' to Dark Charterlands to introduce elements of surprise and bluffing. These should be designed to be instantaneous and tested thoroughly to ensure they do not slow down the game, especially in the multiplayer free-for-all format. The rules for when these actions can be played should be clear and balanced.
- **The speaker discusses the importance of considering different player types and playstyles when designing a trading card game.** (medium). [Leandro, 9:30](#)
 - *For us:* Design Dark Charterlands with various player types in mind, including those who enjoy big effects, tournament players, and experimental players. This will ensure a diverse and engaging player base.
- **The boarding mechanic in the game needs to be adjusted to improve gameplay.** (medium). [Leandro, 4:30](#)

- *For us:* Review the mechanics of the game to ensure that abilities are streamlined and do not add unnecessary complexity. Consider if any abilities in Dark Charterlands could be keyworded or simplified to improve gameplay.
- **Significant gameplay changes have been made, including updates to cargo and shield abilities.** (medium). [Leandro, 1:20](#)
 - *For us:* Consider how abilities like cargo and shields can be adapted to Dark Charterlands to add depth to gameplay. For example, units with scalable cargo abilities could carry varying amounts of Seals (the resource), and shields could protect units from the first X damage each turn, enhancing strategic decisions.
- **The video describes the detailed description process for each card, which includes specifying the color scheme, environment, focus, and ability of the card.** (medium). [Leandro, 1:34](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that the descriptions for each card in Dark Charterlands are detailed and clear, including color schemes, environments, and the focus of the card. This will help illustrators create artwork that accurately reflects the card's abilities and types, making it easier for new players to understand the game.
- **The video outlines the iterative process of refining the artwork, involving initial sketches, working progress, and final illustrations.** (medium). [Leandro, 5:18](#)
 - *For us:* Establish a clear iterative process for refining artwork in Dark Charterlands, involving initial sketches, working progress, and final illustrations. This will ensure that the artwork is of high quality and accurately represents the card's abilities and types.
- **The speaker iteratively redesigned the card layout to maximize image space and improve visual appeal.** (medium). [Leandro, 13:42](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that the card layout for Dark Charterlands is visually appealing and functional. Consider the placement of text, images, and other elements to maximize readability and aesthetic appeal.
- **The speaker encountered and resolved several design issues, such as color problems and text placement.** (medium). [Leandro, 15:31](#)
 - *For us:* Pay close attention to the printing process for Dark Charterlands. Ensure that the colors are vibrant and that the text is well-placed and easy to read.
- **The speaker discussed the challenges of integrating new designs with existing artwork.** (medium). [Leandro, 20:12](#)
 - *For us:* Be prepared for potential challenges when integrating new designs with existing artwork. Consult with illustrators to ensure that the artwork fits well with the new format, and be willing to make adjustments as needed.

Onboarding & complexity

- **The video explains the fundamental concepts of TCGs and how they differ from traditional card games** (high). [Leandro, 0:57](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that no single card or ability in Dark Charterlands is objectively better than others to maintain balance. This is crucial for a high-depth strategy game like ours, where players should have meaningful choices and no clear 'best' cards.

- **The creator plans to test the game with new players who have never played trading card games before.** (high). [Leandro, 3:45](#)
 - *For us:* Conduct playtesting sessions with new players to assess the game's accessibility. Ensure that the rules and mechanics are easy to understand for players who are new to trading card games. Simplify the game's complexity where possible to make it more approachable.
- **The speaker outlines various strategies to reduce the complexity and barrier of entry for new players in TCGs.** (high). [Leandro, 9:50](#)
 - *For us:* The team should design preconstructed decks for Dark Charterlands that are easy to understand and use. These decks can serve as a starting point for new players and help them grasp the fundamentals of the game. Additionally, dividing the game into different modes with varying levels of complexity can cater to both new and experienced players.
- **The speaker suggests several strategies to lower the complexity barrier for new players in trading card games.** (high). [Leandro, 12:36](#)
 - *For us:* Incorporating tutorials and preconstructed decks into Dark Charterlands can significantly enhance the onboarding experience for new players. Simplifying common cards can also make the game more accessible without compromising its depth.
- **The game's rules and card wordings have been updated to improve clarity and balance.** (high). [Leandro, 1:11](#)
 - *For us:* Regularly update and refine the game's rules and card wordings to improve clarity. This will help new players understand the game more quickly and reduce confusion.
- **The speaker discusses the importance of clear and unambiguous card wording in a trading card game.** (high). [Leandro, 12:19](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure card wording is clear and unambiguous to avoid misinterpretation. This may involve revising wording multiple times based on playtesting feedback. Consider the limited space on the card and aim for simplicity.
- **The speaker describes changes made to the terminology used on cards to improve readability.** (high). [Leandro, 16:05](#)
 - *For us:* Use intuitive and straightforward terminology on cards to improve readability. Avoid complex phrases and opt for simple terms that convey the same meaning.
- **The video explains the design of the card front, including the layout of text and visual elements, and the creation of different color variations.** (high). [Leandro, 10:09](#)
 - *For us:* Design the card front in Dark Charterlands to be clean and easy to read, with the image of the card's subject prominently displayed. Arrange text and visual elements in a logical order, with the name of the card at the top, followed by the type line, text box, cost and stats, and additional information at the bottom.
- **The speaker designed the card layout to clearly display cost and stats, using separate symbols for each resource to avoid confusion.** (high). [Leandro, 13:49](#)
 - *For us:* Use separate symbols for each resource in Dark Charterlands to avoid confusion, especially for those unfamiliar with the game. Design the card layout to clearly show the cost and stats of each card, with higher costs moving to the bottom row. Ensure that the design allows for cards with costs up to 12 resources, although no cards currently cost 12.
- **The creator identified and addressed complexity issues with two-colored planets in the game.** (medium). [Leandro, 0:24](#)

- *For us:* Avoid overly complex resource management for new players. Simplify the tracking of resources, especially in multi-resource systems. Consider how new players will handle multiple resources and adjust accordingly.
- **The term 'creatures' is being renamed to 'units' for clarity and consistency.** (medium). [Leandro, 16:00](#)
 - *For us:* The team should use clear and consistent terminology in Dark Charterlands. If there are entities that function similarly to units but are not traditionally considered 'units', consider renaming them for clarity. This will help reduce confusion for new players and streamline the learning process.
- **The speaker decides to remove activated abilities from the current set of cards.** (medium). [Leandro, 15:10](#)
 - *For us:* Consider removing or simplifying activated abilities in Dark Charterlands to make the game more accessible for new players. Ensure that the game's mechanics are intuitive and do not overwhelm beginners.
- **The speaker discusses the complexity inherent in trading card games (TCGs) and the challenges it poses for new players.** (medium). [Leandro, 6:29](#)
 - *For us:* Dark Charterlands should consider creating a base set with simpler cards to help new players understand the game mechanics. Additionally, providing clear and concise rules explanations and tutorials can lower the barrier to entry.

Playtesting & metrics

- **The creator plans to conduct a test session with friends to evaluate the game's playability and fun factor.** (high). [Leandro, 4:15](#)
 - *For us:* Plan regular test sessions with a diverse group of players to evaluate the playability and fun factor of Dark Charterlands. Focus on assessing the game's pace, identifying overpowered or underpowered cards, and making necessary adjustments based on feedback. This will help ensure that the game remains balanced and enjoyable.
- **The creator has sent out monocolored decks to subscribers for testing and feedback.** (high). [Leandro, 8:56](#)
 - *For us:* The team should conduct extensive playtesting with the community, similar to the testing phase described in the video. This will help gather feedback and refine the game's mechanics and balance. The team should consider sending out pre-release draft kits to trusted community members or influencers to generate buzz and gather feedback.
- **A recent playtest session revealed several issues that need to be addressed in the game.** (high). [Leandro, 7:02](#)
 - *For us:* Conduct thorough playtesting to identify under-supported strategies and mechanics. Ensure that all cards and abilities are well-tested, especially those that are central to the game's strategy. Be prepared to iterate on card designs based on playtest feedback.
- **The creator has conducted internal testing of the game's cards and found the results to be positive overall, with some balance issues to address.** (high). [Leandro, 8:52](#)
 - *For us:* The team should conduct internal testing of Dark Charterlands' cards to identify any balance issues before wider playtesting. Pay special attention to factions that might be underpowered or overpowered, and adjust their cards accordingly. Ensure that each faction has viable strategies and moments of success.

- **The creator is making significant changes to card mechanics based on testing and feedback.** (high). [Leandro, 8:47](#)
 - *For us:* The team should be prepared to make significant changes to card mechanics based on testing and feedback. This includes addressing overpowered and underpowered abilities, and considering replacements for mechanics that are not working as intended. For example, they should test the balance of abilities like 'flight' and 'quick shot' to ensure they fit well within the game's mechanics.
- **A community play-testing session for Multiverse Cosmic Conquest is scheduled to start on March 14th and will run for 10 days.** (high). [Leandro, 11:39](#)
 - *For us:* Plan organized play-testing sessions to gather constructive feedback. Focus on the new version of the base set and encourage participants to build decks using specific factions to test balance and strategy.
- **The creator has identified a strategic issue in the game and is considering changes to the rules to encourage more exploration.** (medium). [Leandro, 0:45](#)
 - *For us:* The team should consider if there are any dominant strategies in Dark Charterlands that might make the game feel too linear or rushed. If so, they should explore ways to encourage more varied playstyles, such as by adding multiple paths to victory or incentives for exploring different strategies. This could involve adjusting the rules or adding new mechanics to the game.
- **The creator plans to organize another test session before making any fixes.** (medium). [Leandro, 13:39](#)
 - *For us:* Plan multiple playtest sessions with the same group of players to gather consistent data. This will help in making informed decisions about balancing and game design.
- **The speaker is inviting subscribers to participate in the development process of Multiverse by testing the game and providing feedback.** (medium). [Leandro, 13:05](#)
 - *For us:* The team should actively engage with the community to gather feedback and test the game. This can help identify balance issues and ensure that the game is well-received by players. Encouraging community involvement can also foster a sense of ownership and investment in the game.

Business & distribution

- **The lack of a physical prototype and the hybrid nature of the game made it difficult to get coverage from reviewers.** (medium). [Leandro, 4:29](#)
 - *For us:* Ensure that Dark Charterlands has a physical prototype ready for reviewers. Consider creating a simple, engaging tutorial or quick-start guide to help reviewers understand the game's unique mechanics, such as the multiplayer free-for-all format and the use of Seals as a resource.
- **The team decided to pivot to a living card game format due to financial constraints and market realities.** (medium). [Leandro, 7:37](#)
 - *For us:* Be prepared for potential resistance from board game reviewers who may dislike trading card games. Highlight the unique aspects of Dark Charterlands, such as the multiplayer free-for-all format and the Community Charters system, to generate interest.
- **The speaker learned valuable lessons from the printing experience.** (medium). [Leandro, 25:26](#)
 - *For us:* Learn from the printing experience and use it to inform design decisions. Pay close attention to issues like color bleeding and text placement, and be willing to make adjustments as needed.

Per video

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 1

Leandro · 27,577 views

Summary: The video is an in-depth look at the creation and mechanics of a new trading card game called 'The Mothership'. It explores the fundamental concepts of TCGs, the importance of balance, and the resource system, while also providing insights into the card design process, including the use of color-based strategies and the creation of unique concepts like teleporting creatures. The video also offers a behind-the-scenes look at the development process.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the importance of balance and intuitive card design in creating an engaging and strategic trading card game.

- **0:57 The video explains the fundamental concepts of TCGs and how they differ from traditional card games** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)
 - The speaker explains that TCGs are games that are bigger than the box, meaning they have thousands of different cards, but players only use a small sample of those cards in their decks. This allows players to choose their cards and customize their decks, giving them freedom to decide on their strategies. The speaker also discusses the importance of balance in TCGs, using an example of a poker game where players can bring their own customized decks. If some cards are objectively better than others, the game becomes unbalanced and less enjoyable.
 - *For us:* Ensure that no single card or ability in Dark Charterlands is objectively better than others to maintain balance. This is crucial for a high-depth strategy game like ours, where players should have meaningful choices and no clear 'best' cards.
- **5:12 The video outlines the resource system and color-based strategies in 'The Mothership'** (*Resource system, medium*)
 - The speaker describes the resource system in 'The Mothership', where players start on their home planet and produce resources each turn. Cards have a resource cost, and players must decide whether to play cards immediately or save resources for more powerful cards later. The game features four different flavors of resources, each represented by a different color. Each color has its own characteristics and strategies, such as red valuing courage and strength, blue valuing intelligence and planning, green valuing cooperation and growth, and yellow valuing political and economic power. This system allows for a variety of strategies and keeps the game balanced.
 - *For us:* Consider a color-based strategy system for Dark Charterlands, where each faction has unique characteristics and strategies. This could add depth to the game and encourage diverse deck-building approaches.
- **11:47 The video provides a behind-the-scenes look at the card creation process** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker shows the process of creating cards for 'The Mothership' using Excel to keep the card database sorted. The speaker mentions that the current database contains an old version of the resource system with six colors, but many of these cards will be recycled into the new database. The speaker also discusses the process of coming up with ideas for cards and testing them with friends to ensure the game works even in its raw form.
 - *For us:* Keep the initial card pool and rules simple to ease players into the game. As players become more familiar with the game, gradually introduce more complex cards and mechanics.

- **16:22 The speaker explains the top-down approach to card design, starting with a concept and then fitting it into the game.** (*Card & mechanic design, high*)
 - The speaker describes designing a card that teleports creatures from one place to another as an example of the top-down approach. This involves starting with the idea of teleporting creatures and then creating a card that fits this concept within the game's rules. The speaker suggests that this method is effective for creating cards that feel natural and intuitive, as it aligns with preconceived notions about the card's function. The speaker also mentions that they generally prefer this top-down approach for designing cards.
 - *For us:* Use a top-down approach for designing unique and intuitive cards in Dark Charterlands. Start with a concept that fits the game's lore and then create mechanics around it. This will help ensure that cards feel natural and fit well within the game.
- **16:34 The speaker describes the bottom-up approach to card design, starting with a desired effect and then creating a concept around it.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker contrasts the top-down approach with the bottom-up approach, where one starts with a desired effect and then creates a concept around it. For example, if the desired effect is a powerful blue action that helps control the situation, the designer would come up with a concept like teleporting creatures. The speaker suggests that this method can also be effective, but they generally prefer the top-down approach for creating cards that feel natural and intuitive.
 - *For us:* Consider using a bottom-up approach for designing specific effects or abilities in Dark Charterlands. This can help create powerful and unique cards that fit specific strategic needs.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 2

Leandro · 7,442 views

Summary: The video is a continuation of a series where the creator is designing a trading card game set in space. The creator discusses the initial list of cards, their rarity, and the basic structure of the game, including different types of cards and their roles. The creator also talks about the design process and the challenges faced while creating the cards.

Lesson for us: The team should focus on creating clear roles and identities for cards, distributing card types thoughtfully, and considering unique elements to enhance the game's strategic depth and pacing.

- **0:10 The creator outlines the initial list of cards and their roles in the game.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The creator has made a list of cards that are essential for a space adventure game, including roles like engineer, scientist, doctor, pilot, robot pilot, astronomer, and captain. Each card has a certain identity and fits a certain color, such as blue, green, yellow, or red. The creator also mentions that the game will have 200 cards in total, divided into Commons, Uncommons, and Rares, with each rarity serving a specific purpose in the game.
 - *For us:* Ensure that each card in Dark Charterlands has a clear role and identity, similar to the roles outlined for the space adventure game. This will help in balancing the game and providing clear strategies for players. Consider the rarity of cards and their roles in the game, such as Commons, Uncommons, and Rares, to maintain a balanced and engaging gameplay experience.
- **2:05 The creator discusses the structure and design process of the game, including the distribution of card types and colors.** (*Draft & set structure, medium*)

- The creator explains that the game will have 40% creatures, 30% ships, 20% actions, and 10% buildings. These cards are divided into different colors, with each color having a specific number of Commons, Uncommons, and Rares. The creator also mentions that they will design each color individually to ensure clear strategies. Additionally, the creator discusses the concept of Galaxy cards, which are separate from the main deck and are used to construct the game board.
- *For us:* Distribute card types in Dark Charterlands thoughtfully, considering the balance between different types of cards (e.g., units, structures, abilities) and their roles in the game. This will help in creating clear strategies and maintaining a balanced gameplay experience.
- **4:34 The creator explores the concept of Galaxy cards and their role in the game.** (*Card & mechanic design, low*)
 - Galaxy cards are a fourth type of card that are not part of the main deck. They include planets and other galactic elements that players use to construct a 10-card deck. These decks are shuffled with the opponent's deck and distributed throughout the game board. The creator discusses different types of Galaxy cards, such as volcanic planets, forest planets, storm planets, and rocky planets, each providing different resources. The creator also mentions other potential Galaxy cards like asteroids, nebulae, black holes, and voids, each with unique effects.
 - *For us:* Consider introducing unique elements to Dark Charterlands that are separate from the main deck, similar to Galaxy cards. These elements could add variety and strategic depth to the game, influencing the turn structure and pacing. For example, unique terrain or event cards could be used to construct the game board and affect gameplay.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 3

Leandro · 8,173 views

Summary: In this video, the host and a guest discuss the development of a trading card game, focusing on the creation of cards, balancing mechanics, and the impact of different strategies. They delve into the concept of 'impact' as a measure of a card's effectiveness and how it relates to resource costs and game turns.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson for the team is to focus on balancing cards based on their impact and resource costs, considering the value of having cards in hand and the additional reward for waiting extra turns to play higher-cost cards.

- **2:45 The host introduces a formula to balance the cards based on their impact and resource cost.** (*Costing & balance, high*)
 - The host explains that the impact of a card is a measure of its effectiveness in the game. They propose that a card's impact should be equal to its resource cost minus a variable 'x', which represents the value of having a card in your hand. The host suggests that 'x' is likely around 0.5, but it can vary depending on the game's length. The host also discusses how waiting an extra turn to play a higher-cost card should provide an additional reward.
 - *For us:* The team should develop a formula to balance cards based on their impact and resource cost. This formula should consider the value of having a card in hand and the additional reward for waiting an extra turn to play a higher-cost card. This will help ensure that cards are balanced and that their costs are appropriate for their effects.
- **10:45 The host discusses the concept of 'impact' and how it relates to resource costs and game turns.** (*Costing & balance, high*)

- The host explains that the impact of a card is not directly related to its power, health, and speed but rather represents the whole effect that the card has. They also discuss how the impact of a card changes based on the number of resources it costs and the number of turns it takes to play. The host provides examples of how the impact of cards with different resource costs would change over the course of the game.
- *For us:* The team should consider the impact of cards in relation to their resource costs and the number of turns it takes to play them. This means evaluating the overall effect of a card, not just its individual stats. Cards with higher resource costs should provide a greater reward to justify waiting additional turns.
- **11:27 The host and guest discuss different strategies in the game, such as aggressive and defensive strategies, and how they affect the impact of cards. (Costing & balance, medium)**
 - The host and guest discuss how different strategies in the game can affect the impact of cards. They mention that an aggressive strategy might have a higher impact at the beginning of the game but lose its advantage as the game progresses. A defensive strategy, on the other hand, might have a lower impact at the beginning but gain an advantage as the game goes on. The host also provides examples of how the impact of cards would change based on these strategies.
 - *For us:* The team should design cards with different strategies in mind, understanding that aggressive and defensive strategies will affect the impact of cards differently over the course of the game. This means creating cards that are effective in various strategies and at different stages of the game.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 4

Leandro · 5,718 views

Summary: The video offers a comprehensive look into the creation and mechanics of the trading card game 'Mothership', including the development challenges and gameplay rules. It also provides an overview of the game's core mechanics, deck-building strategies, and various play formats, with a focus on limited formats. The creator also mentions their upcoming exam session and a temporary hiatus from uploading content.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the significance of balancing game mechanics through mathematical models and designing for multiple player configurations to ensure a fair and engaging experience for all players.

- **0:41 The game 'Mothership' supports multiple player configurations, including two, three, four, and six players. (Multiplayer & politics, high)**
 - The game is designed to accommodate different numbers of players, with specific boards or 'galaxies' for each configuration. The creator mentions that playing with five players is unusual and not typically recommended. The game's flexibility in player count is a key feature, allowing for a variety of gaming experiences.
 - *For us:* Consider designing specific boards or 'galaxies' for different player counts, such as 3 or 4 players, to optimize the multiplayer experience. Ensure that the game's mechanics scale well with the number of players, and avoid configurations that are not typically recommended, such as five players.
- **1:25 The creator has developed a cost impact curve to balance the game's mechanics. (Costing & balance, high)**
 - The cost impact curve is a mathematical model used to balance the game's resources and impacts. The creator explains that for one resource, you get one impact, for two resources, you get 1.6 impacts, and so on. This curve helps ensure that the game is balanced and fair for all players. The creator mentions trying different methods, including solving it as a parabolic function, but ultimately settled on a specific algorithm.

- *For us:* Develop a cost impact curve to balance the game's resources and impacts. This will help ensure that the game is balanced and fair for all players. Consider using a mathematical model where the impact increases non-linearly with the cost, such as 1.6 impacts for two resources.
- **5:56 The game features different types of cards, including Arsenal cards and Galaxy cards.** (*Card & mechanic design, low*)
 - Arsenal cards are the main cards used in the game and are divided into actions, creatures, and structures. These cards are what players use to build their decks and interact with the game. Galaxy cards, on the other hand, form a separate deck and are used to create the game board. The creator explains that Galaxy cards cannot be played like Arsenal cards and are used to explore and colonize the game's universe.
 - *For us:* Design different types of cards, such as Arsenal cards and Galaxy cards, to create a variety of gameplay experiences. Ensure that these cards have distinct roles and cannot be used interchangeably. For example, Galaxy cards could be used to create the game board, while Arsenal cards are used to build decks and interact with the game.
- **12:37 The game's objective is to destroy all creatures on the opponent's planet and place your own creature there to win.** (*Turn structure & pacing, medium*)
 - The game involves attacking with creatures or structures to destroy the opponent's creatures. The attacking and defending cards must be on the same top, unless a special ability called range is present. The game is turn-based, with each turn consisting of different phases: beginning, main, battle, and ending. The main phase is where most actions, including attacks, occur. The battle phase is triggered when an attack is initiated, and both the attacker and defender deal damage simultaneously.
 - *For us:* Design a turn-based structure with distinct phases, such as beginning, main, battle, and ending. Ensure that the main phase is where most actions, including attacks, occur, and that the battle phase is triggered when an attack is initiated. This will create a clear and engaging gameplay experience.
- **16:39 The game features different formats of play, including constructed and limited, with the speaker preferring limited formats.** (*Draft & set structure, medium*)
 - Constructed play involves preparing a deck beforehand based on one's collection. Limited play, on the other hand, involves building a deck on the fly by opening packs or products of the game. The speaker expresses a preference for limited formats because they find them fairer, as everyone has the same chance of winning before the tournament starts.
 - *For us:* Consider focusing on limited formats for playtesting and tournaments, as they are generally fairer and provide a more level playing field. This will help ensure that the game is balanced and enjoyable for all players, regardless of their collection size.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 5

Leandro · 5,730 views

Summary: The video documents the creator's progress in developing a trading card game, focusing on designing and testing the common cards. The creator discusses the importance of simplicity and versatility in common cards, introduces new keywords for battling mechanics, and shares the process of creating and testing the game with friends.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the significance of thorough playtesting and the design of versatile, simple common cards to ensure a balanced and engaging gameplay experience.

- **0:44 The creator has completed designing the common cards for the trading card game, emphasizing their simplicity and versatility.** (*Card & mechanic design, high*)

- The common cards are considered the foundation of any trading card game and need to be simple to understand and versatile enough to be used in many different situations. The creator has designed these cards to utilize all features of the game, such as the game board, power, health, speed, distance, and cards in players' hands. The common cards are designed to be all-purpose and general enough to be used in various situations, ensuring they are not too narrow in their effects.
- *For us:* Ensure that the common cards in Dark Charterlands are designed to be simple and versatile, so they can be used in a variety of situations. This will help maintain balance and ensure that players have useful options regardless of their draft. Avoid making common cards too situational or narrow in their effects.
- **1:45 The creator introduces new keywords for battling mechanics, including 'First Strike', 'Range', and 'Shields'. (Card & mechanic design, medium)**
 - The keywords 'First Strike', 'Range', and 'Shields' are introduced to add depth to the battling mechanics. 'First Strike' allows a card to deal damage first in battle, 'Range' enables a card to attack from a distance, and 'Shields' provides a defensive ability that reduces damage. These keywords are designed to create interesting dynamics in battle and vary the gameplay, making it more engaging.
 - *For us:* Consider introducing keywords or mechanics that add depth to the combat and strategy in Dark Charterlands. Keywords like 'First Strike', 'Range', and 'Shields' can create interesting dynamics and vary the gameplay, making it more engaging. Think about how these or similar mechanics can be integrated into the COMMIT and CONTEST phases.
- **4:15 The creator plans to conduct a test session with friends to evaluate the game's playability and fun factor. (Playtesting & metrics, high)**
 - The creator mentions that a test session is scheduled with friends to determine if the game is playable, fun, and to identify any broken or weak cards. The session will focus on assessing the game's pace, identifying overpowered or underpowered cards, and making necessary adjustments based on the feedback. The creator also discusses the logistics of printing and preparing the cards for the test session.
 - *For us:* Plan regular test sessions with a diverse group of players to evaluate the playability and fun factor of Dark Charterlands. Focus on assessing the game's pace, identifying overpowered or underpowered cards, and making necessary adjustments based on feedback. This will help ensure that the game remains balanced and enjoyable.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 6

Leandro · 5,345 views

Summary: The video discusses the first test session of a trading card game called 'Mothership,' highlighting the playability of the game, balance issues among different colors, and specific problems with certain cards and rules. The creator also shares plans for future test sessions and the development of a data model for a potential online version of the game.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the importance of iterative playtesting and balancing, especially when introducing new mechanics or factions, to ensure a smooth and engaging gameplay experience.

- **0:26 The first test session of the trading card game 'Mothership' was successful, but balance issues were identified among different colors. (Costing & balance, high)**

- The game was playable, and players won and lost as intended. However, the blue color was the strongest, followed by yellow, while green and red were weaker. The red color's weakness was partly due to players not using the deck correctly and not playing an aggressive strategy. The creator also noted that certain cards, like the 'corruptor' and a green creature with a powerful ability, were broken and needed adjustments.
- *For us:* The team should carefully balance the factions (colors) in Dark Charterlands, ensuring that no faction is overpowered or underpowered. Pay special attention to the power level of individual cards, especially those with unique or powerful abilities. Consider the strategies players might employ with each faction and adjust accordingly.
- **1:32 Specific rules and card abilities were identified as problematic and will be adjusted for future test sessions.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The rule preventing creatures from moving inside a structure and attacking on the same turn was changed because it slowed down the game. The range ability for creatures was also deemed impractical, as it allowed creatures to shoot at spaceships in space. The first strike ability was rarely relevant and will be replaced with an ability that allows creatures to deal damage while inside structures or ships. The creator plans to fix these issues in the next test session.
 - *For us:* Review the rules and card abilities in Dark Charterlands to ensure they do not slow down the game or are impractical. Consider the flow of the game and how different abilities interact with the core loop. Make sure that abilities are relevant and impactful within the context of the game's turn structure.
- **3:45 The creator plans to test the game with new players who have never played trading card games before.** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)
 - The next test session will involve players who are new to trading card games to see how easily they can understand and learn the game. The creator also plans to test two-color decks, which were not tested in the first session. This will help in assessing the game's accessibility and balance.
 - *For us:* Conduct playtesting sessions with new players to assess the game's accessibility. Ensure that the rules and mechanics are easy to understand for players who are new to trading card games. Simplify the game's complexity where possible to make it more approachable.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 7

Leandro · 3,458 views

Summary: The video documents the creator's ongoing development and testing of a trading card game, focusing on issues encountered during playtesting and adjustments made to the game's mechanics and design. The creator discusses changes to two-colored planets, the balance of cards, and the potential for live streams and future content.

Lesson for us: Simplify complex mechanics for new players and ensure decks encourage strategic variety through balanced high-end cards.

- **0:24 The creator identified and addressed complexity issues with two-colored planets in the game.** (*Onboarding & complexity, medium*)
 - The creator found that two-colored planets, which initially added one colored resource and one colorless resource, were too complicated for new players to track. This complexity was exacerbated when multiple such planets were in play. To simplify, the creator changed the planets to add specific colored resources without requiring players to choose, making it easier to keep track of resources. This change was tested and found to improve playability.

- *For us:* Avoid overly complex resource management for new players. Simplify the tracking of resources, especially in multi-resource systems. Consider how new players will handle multiple resources and adjust accordingly.
- **4:23 The creator discovered that players tended to use a straightforward strategy due to the lack of high-end cards and coherent strategies in the decks.** (*Costing & balance, high*)
 - During testing, it was observed that players primarily used a middle path to attack their opponent's home planet rather than exploring more spaces. This behavior was attributed to the decks being composed of common cards without high-end cards that would incentivize more strategic play. The creator noted that this lack of variety in strategies was partly due to the decks being a collection of common cards without a clear strategy.
 - *For us:* Ensure that decks have a variety of high-end cards and coherent strategies to encourage more strategic play. Test decks to make sure they incentivize different approaches beyond straightforward attacks.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 8

Leandro · 2,500 views

Summary: The video discusses the development of a trading card game, focusing on making the basic set draftable. The speaker explains the draft format, the strategies involved, and the process of creating and balancing the cards. Additionally, the speaker shares updates on artwork, streaming plans, and plans to involve subscribers in testing the game.

Lesson for us: Balancing cards and creating a diverse set of strategies are crucial for a successful draft format in a trading card game.

- **0:11 The speaker is working on making the basic set of their trading card game draftable, involving multiple strategies and balanced cards.** (*Draft & set structure, high*)
 - The speaker explains that draft is a popular format in trading card games where players build decks from cards they open in booster packs. For their game, the speaker is designing a set with 10 different strategies, including four monocolored and six two-colored strategies. The speaker is in the process of creating and balancing these cards, which involves reusing interesting cards from previous sets and ensuring that each strategy has similar support. The speaker mentions that this process will take about a week to complete.
 - *For us:* Ensure that each of the 10 two-faction draft archetypes in Dark Charterlands has similar support and is balanced. Reuse interesting cards from previous sets or other games to maintain consistency. This will help in creating a diverse and strategic draft experience.
- **2:42 The speaker discusses the process of creating booster packs and the rarity of cards within them.** (*Draft & set structure, medium*)
 - The speaker details the composition of booster packs, which include 10 Commons, 3 uncommons, 1 rare, and 1 Galaxy card. Uncommon cards are twice as hard to find as Commons, and rares are twice as hard to find as uncommons. The speaker uses a program to generate the distribution of these cards and plans to print the boosters once the basic set is finished. This process ensures that each booster pack contains unique cards, adding to the excitement and strategy of the game.
 - *For us:* Design booster packs with a clear rarity distribution to maintain balance and excitement. Ensure that each pack contains a mix of Commons, Uncommons, Rares, and unique cards to keep the draft experience engaging.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 9

Leandro · 2,439 views

Summary: The video details the creation and balancing of a trading card game set, including the distribution of cards by rarity and strategy, and the unique mechanics and races associated with each color strategy. The creator also discusses plans for testing the game and gathering feedback from subscribers.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the significance of playtesting and balancing unique mechanics and strategies to ensure a well-rounded and engaging gameplay experience.

- **0:32 The game set consists of 200 Arsenal cards and 14 Galaxy cards, with a specific rarity distribution to balance the game.** (*Draft & set structure, medium*)
 - The set includes 100 common cards, 60 uncommon cards, and 40 rare cards. The Galaxy cards include 10 planets, an asteroid field, a nebula, a void, and a wormhole. The rarity distribution is designed to make uncommon cards twice as rare as common cards, and rare cards twice as rare as uncommon cards. This distribution ensures that the probability of drawing specific cards aligns with their rarity, affecting gameplay balance.
 - *For us:* The team should consider a similar rarity distribution for Dark Charterlands to ensure that the probability of drawing specific cards aligns with their rarity and power level. This will help maintain gameplay balance, especially since booster draft is the primary way to play. The team should also consider how the rarity distribution affects the drafting experience and the overall meta.
- **1:39 The game features 10 monocolored strategies and 6 two-colored strategies, each with unique mechanics and races.** (*Card & mechanic design, high*)
 - Each color strategy has its own playstyle and strengths. For example, the red strategy focuses on fast creatures and direct damage, while the blue strategy is defensive and card-drawing. The two-colored strategies offer more complex interactions and can combine the strengths of their constituent colors. The creator has designed specific races for each strategy, such as minur people for red and squids for blue.
 - *For us:* The team should design each faction and two-faction archetype in Dark Charterlands with unique mechanics and playstyles, similar to the color strategies in the video. This will provide players with distinct choices and strategies during the draft and gameplay. The team should also consider how these archetypes interact with each other and the overall game balance.
- **8:56 The creator has sent out monocolored decks to subscribers for testing and feedback.** (*Playtesting & metrics, high*)
 - The creator has created four monocolored decks and sent them to subscribers for testing. This testing phase is crucial for gathering feedback and ensuring the game's balance. Subscribers who have not yet received a deck can still apply by sending an email to the creator. The feedback from this testing phase will be instrumental in refining the game's mechanics and balance.
 - *For us:* The team should conduct extensive playtesting with the community, similar to the testing phase described in the video. This will help gather feedback and refine the game's mechanics and balance. The team should consider sending out pre-release draft kits to trusted community members or influencers to generate buzz and gather feedback.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 10

Leandro · 2,350 views

Summary: The video documents the speaker's process of preparing for and conducting a test draft of a trading card game called Multiverse. The speaker discusses the challenges encountered during the draft, the insights

gained from playing various game configurations, and the design work being done for the game's cards and logo.

Lesson for us: It is crucial to test and iterate on game design based on real play experiences, especially when it comes to pacing and luck, to ensure a balanced and engaging experience for all players.

- **4:05 The 3-player draft game was too long and highlighted issues with galaxy size and ship movement.** (*Multiplayer & politics, high*)
 - The 3-player game took approximately 2 hours and was deemed too long. The large galaxy size and the movement speed of ships made it difficult for players to engage in combat quickly. The speaker noted that the distance between home planets was too great, requiring multiple turns just to reach an opponent's home planet. Additionally, the draft decks used were not pre-constructed and lacked power, contributing to the game's length.
 - *For us:* Ensure that the game's core loop is designed to be completed in a reasonable amount of time, especially for the multiplayer free-for-all format. Consider adjusting the size of the game area (the map) and the movement speed of units to facilitate quicker engagement and resolution of conflicts. This will help keep games within the 20-40 minute target.
- **7:55 The speaker discovered that the balance between creatures and ships in Multiverse adds an element of luck to the game.** (*Resource system, medium*)
 - The speaker observed that the game's resource system, which is separate from the deck, requires a balance between creatures and ships. Without enough of either, players cannot effectively move their creatures to attack opponents. This balance introduces a luck element, which can be both engaging for new players and frustrating for experienced ones if it becomes overwhelming. The speaker suggests that certain decks, particularly those with blue cards, might be able to minimize this luck element.
 - *For us:* Be mindful of the balance between different types of cards (units, Edicts, Holdings, Relics) and how they interact with the resource system (Seals). Ensure that the game does not become overly reliant on luck, which could frustrate experienced players. Consider testing different deck compositions to identify any potential issues with luck and balance.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 11

Leandro · 3,217 views

Summary: The video discusses the development of a trading card game called Multiverse TCG. The creator shares updates on the game's logo, card design, and gameplay mechanics. He also talks about plans to create a website for the game, detailing the features and structure of the site.

Lesson for us: The team should be prepared to iterate on gameplay mechanics based on playtesting feedback, especially if certain strategies become too dominant.

- **0:45 The creator has identified a strategic issue in the game and is considering changes to the rules to encourage more exploration.** (*Playtesting & metrics, medium*)
 - The creator has been testing the game and has found that the best strategy is to fly straight to the opponent's planet and conquer it as fast as possible, rather than exploring the galaxy. He has tried to support more expansive strategies by giving bonuses for exploration, but he realized he was approaching the problem from the wrong angle. He is considering changing the goal of the game to include multiple ways of winning, such as conquering the opponent's home planet or conquering 10 planets in the galaxy.

- *For us:* The team should consider if there are any dominant strategies in Dark Charterlands that might make the game feel too linear or rushed. If so, they should explore ways to encourage more varied playstyles, such as by adding multiple paths to victory or incentives for exploring different strategies. This could involve adjusting the rules or adding new mechanics to the game.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 12

Leandro · 1,886 views

Summary: The video provides an in-depth look into the development of the trading card game Multiverse, highlighting the evolution of its card layouts, resource system, color system, and strategic mechanics. It also offers updates on the game's artwork and the progress of its base set.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the significance of iterative design and playtesting in creating a balanced and engaging trading card game, particularly in refining resource systems and strategic dynamics.

- **4:09 The game introduces multiple strategic dynamics, including aggressive vs. defensive play, direct vs. expansive strategies, and attacking with creatures vs. attacking with ships.** (*Card & mechanic design, high*)
 - The speaker discusses the strategic dynamics introduced by the new mechanics in the game. The resource system creates a dynamic of aggressive (aggro) and defensive (control) strategies. Additionally, the game introduces an expansive way to win by conquering planets, adding another layer of strategy. The new boarding mechanic allows players to choose between attacking with creatures or ships, further enhancing the depth of gameplay. The speaker notes that these dynamics make the game more strategic and allow for a variety of deck types and scenarios.
 - *For us:* Dark Charterlands should incorporate multiple strategic dynamics to keep the game engaging. This includes considering aggressive vs. defensive playstyles, direct vs. expansive strategies, and different types of attacks. The team should design mechanics that allow for these dynamics, ensuring that players have meaningful choices throughout the game.
- **6:25 The resource system of the game has evolved significantly, moving from a literal interpretation of resources to a more thematic and strategic approach.** (*Resource system, high*)
 - The speaker explains the evolution of the resource system in the Multiverse trading card game. Initially, the resources were literal and included food, metal, and energy. However, this system did not create enough variety in gameplay. The speaker then developed a second version with six resources: food, metal, energy, labor, gold, and intelligence, each with a thematic explanation and assigned colors. Despite initial challenges, the system was further refined to four colors, each representing different strategies. The speaker emphasizes the importance of the resource system in creating diverse gameplay experiences.
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that the resource system in Dark Charterlands is not only thematic but also strategically diverse. This means having resources that encourage different playstyles and strategies, similar to how Multiverse evolved its resource system. The team should test various resource configurations to see which ones create the most engaging and varied gameplay experiences.
- **13:33 The speaker rethought the color system of the game Multiverse, leading to a new six-color resource system.** (*Resource system, medium*)

- The speaker initially had issues with the color yellow, as it lacked a distinct identity and was divided into two groups: peaceful conquest methods like economics and trade, and more nefarious tactics like corruption and manipulation. This led to a rethinking of the entire resource system. The new system features six colors, each with a clear identity. Yellow, for example, became primarily associated with diplomacy and economics, while the more negative aspects were moved to purple. This change was influenced by gameplay testing and the addition of new dynamics like boarding and alternative win conditions.
- *For us:* The team should carefully design the faction dynamics in Dark Charterlands to ensure each faction has a clear identity and strategic role. This includes considering how different factions interact with each other and how their unique abilities contribute to the overall gameplay experience. The team should also ensure that the color system, if implemented, is distinct and meaningful.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 13

Leandro · 1,886 views

Summary: The video delves into the intricate process of developing a trading card game, highlighting the artistic creation of cards, the refinement of game mechanics, and the introduction of new card symbols. Additionally, it promotes an upcoming podcast episode, 'Conor Cast', hosted by Conor Linning, which explores game design, trading card games, and music.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the importance of iterative design and playtesting to refine game mechanics and ensure a smooth and engaging player experience, particularly in multiplayer settings.

- **0:26 The speaker is collaborating with an artist to create card art, including a toxic planet and a mountainous planet, with iterative feedback to improve the designs.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker shows the initial and revised versions of the toxic planet art, highlighting the changes made based on feedback, such as adding more detail and adjusting the color to better reflect the card's hue. The speaker also discusses the process of creating the mountainous planet art, including the artist's initial joke about inverting the toxic planet image. The speaker expresses satisfaction with the final versions of the art and plans to use them for the cards.
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that the card art in Dark Charterlands is clear and visually appealing, with iterative feedback from both the design team and playtesters to improve the designs. This will help players understand the game's themes and mechanics more easily.
- **3:26 The speaker is working on improving the game mechanics to prevent stalling and stalemates, particularly in multiplayer games and mirror matches.** (*Turn structure & pacing, high*)
 - The speaker identifies two main issues causing slow gameplay: the low speed of ships and the lack of big, splashy effects that can turn the game in a player's favor. To address these, the speaker has increased the speed of ships across the board and plans to add more high-impact cards that require a lot of resources to use. Additionally, the speaker has changed how shields work to make them more accurate to science fiction depictions and to improve gameplay. The speaker also notes that having alternative win conditions helps mitigate the problem of games dragging on too long.
 - *For us:* The team should identify potential causes of stalling and stalemates in Dark Charterlands, particularly in multiplayer games. They should consider adding high-impact cards that can significantly alter the game state and provide alternative win conditions to keep games dynamic and engaging.

- **9:10 The speaker is redesigning the color symbols for the game's cards to better represent the themes of each color.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker expresses dissatisfaction with the current color symbols, particularly for yellow, blue, purple, and orange, and plans to change them to better represent the themes of each color. For example, the speaker suggests using a scale for yellow to represent balance, an eye for blue to represent knowledge, a gas mask for purple to represent protection, and a hammer for orange to represent labor. The speaker also mentions that they are happy with the current symbols for green and red.
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that the symbols used on cards in Dark Charterlands are intuitive and representative of the themes of each faction. This will help players quickly understand the purpose and function of each card.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 14

Leandro · 1,436 views

Summary: The video is a progress update on the development of a trading card game called Multiverse. The creator discusses updates to the game's rules, the completion of the base set of cards, and the artwork for various planets. Additionally, the creator outlines a one-year plan for the game's release, including a Kickstarter campaign for a digital version.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the significance of thorough balancing and iterative design, along with the importance of high-quality, thematic artwork in enhancing player experience.

- **0:56 The creator has updated the game's rules and completed the base set of cards.** (*Costing & balance, high*)
 - The rules have been updated to include new conditions such as conquering 10 planets and a boarding mechanic. The base set of cards has been fully designed and balanced, with a new algorithm used to ensure that creatures and structures are balanced against each other. The creator mentions that all cards are now ready for printing and testing.
 - *For us:* Ensure that the balancing algorithm for creatures and structures is robust and tested thoroughly. Consider implementing a similar algorithm for balancing units and abilities in Dark Charterlands. Additionally, plan for extensive playtesting to fine-tune the balance of cards.
- **4:03 The creator discusses the artwork for various planets, highlighting the differences and improvements made.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The creator shows artwork for a coniferous forest planet and an urban planet. The urban planet artwork underwent significant changes based on feedback, transitioning from a day scene to a night scene with more realistic skyscrapers and a bridge that connects to something. The creator appreciates the final version, which conveys the city's advanced society and vibrant night life.
 - *For us:* Pay attention to the visual design of cards and ensure that the artwork effectively communicates the theme and mechanics of the game. Consider how the artwork can help players understand the game's lore and mechanics more intuitively.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 15

Leandro · 2,777 views

Summary: The video discusses the development of a trading card game called Multiverse. The creator, Leandro, talks about the extensive work done on the card set, including creating distinct cards with unique interactions and strategies. He also shares insights from a recent playtest session, highlighting issues that need to be addressed and improvements to be made.

Lesson for us: Thorough playtesting and iterative design are crucial for balancing and refining the game's mechanics and strategies.

- **0:26 The creator has been working on creating a diverse and interactive set of cards for the trading card game Multiverse.** (*Card & mechanic design, high*)
 - Leandro has been focusing on making each card distinct with its own flavor and interactions. He has been fine-tuning six monocolored strategies and two-color combinations, which has been a lot of work. He mentions that the set needs to be able to function by itself, so he has been adding as much content as possible without making it too complex.
 - *For us:* Ensure that each card in Dark Characterlands has a unique role and interaction to maintain strategic depth. Avoid making cards too similar to prevent redundancy. Focus on creating distinct strategies for each faction and two-faction archetype.
- **7:02 A recent playtest session revealed several issues that need to be addressed in the game.** (*Playtesting & metrics, high*)
 - During the playtest, it became clear that some strategies, like the expansive strategy, did not have enough support. Additionally, certain cards and mechanics, such as the boarding mechanic and the cargo ability, were not tested thoroughly. The session also highlighted the need for more creatures and for game-changing cards to cost more.
 - *For us:* Conduct thorough playtesting to identify under-supported strategies and mechanics. Ensure that all cards and abilities are well-tested, especially those that are central to the game's strategy. Be prepared to iterate on card designs based on playtest feedback.
- **13:12 The game's length needs to be balanced, as previous iterations had games that were too long, while the current version has games that are too short.** (*Turn structure & pacing, high*)
 - Leandro notes that finding the right balance for game length is challenging. Previous versions of the game had long matches, especially in mirror matches, while the current version has games that end too quickly. He needs to find a balance to ensure games are neither too long nor too short.
 - *For us:* Balance the game's length to ensure matches are engaging but not overly long. Aim for the 20-40 minute range by adjusting the complexity of strategies and the power level of cards. Consider the pacing of the core loop to maintain player engagement.
- **13:39 The creator plans to organize another test session before making any fixes.** (*Playtesting & metrics, medium*)
 - Leandro acknowledges that the recent playtest session was not as productive as previous ones due to the inclusion of new players who needed to learn the basics. He plans to organize another test session with the same cards to gather more data before making any changes.
 - *For us:* Plan multiple playtest sessions with the same group of players to gather consistent data. This will help in making informed decisions about balancing and game design.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 16

Leandro · 1,860 views

Summary: The video presents a comprehensive update on the trading card game Multiverse, highlighting rule changes designed to enhance gameplay dynamics, balance, and excitement, and the introduction of six colors. The speaker also emphasizes community involvement, encouraging viewers to participate in testing and providing feedback to shape the game's future development.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the significance of community involvement and iterative design in shaping a trading card game's dynamics and balance.

- **8:50 The new rules aim to make the expansive strategy viable and add inevitability to games.** (*Costing & balance, high*)
 - The speaker explains that the new rules make the expansive strategy a viable alternative to the direct strategy, giving players a reason to explore the galaxy in every game. This creates in-game dynamics between direct and expansive strategies and adds inevitability to games, ensuring that one player will win after a certain amount of time. The speaker also notes that these changes break up stalemates and make games more interesting and fun.
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that the costs of actions in Dark Charterlands are balanced to avoid games becoming too fast or slow. This includes reviewing the costs of cards and abilities, especially those related to the COMMIT and CONTEST phases, to maintain a healthy pace of gameplay.
- **10:36 Initial testing of the new rules shows promising results but also reveals balance issues.** (*Costing & balance, medium*)
 - The speaker reports that the expansive strategy won a couple of times during the initial testing, which is a positive sign. However, the game has become too fast with the new rule changes, which can be fixed by adjusting the speed of certain cards. Additionally, many actions ended up costing too much or too little, requiring further balancing of action costs.
 - *For us:* The team should design the game to promote dynamic gameplay and inevitability, ensuring that each game has a clear winner after a certain amount of time. This can be achieved by balancing the strategies available to players and ensuring that stalemates are rare.
- **13:05 The speaker is inviting subscribers to participate in the development process of Multiverse by testing the game and providing feedback.** (*Playtesting & metrics, medium*)
 - The speaker announces a plan to send out test decks of Multiverse cards to subscribers, allowing them to print and test the cards. Subscribers who provide useful feedback during the first week of testing will receive an extra color of cards. This initiative aims to grow the community and ensure the game is well-tested.
 - *For us:* The team should actively engage with the community to gather feedback and test the game. This can help identify balance issues and ensure that the game is well-received by players. Encouraging community involvement can also foster a sense of ownership and investment in the game.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 17

Leandro · 1,319 views

Summary: The video discusses the development of a trading card game called Multiverse. The creator outlines plans for playtesting the game, describes updates to the game's design and artwork, and details the process of balancing and testing the game's cards.

Lesson for us: Conduct thorough internal testing to identify and address balance issues before wider playtesting.

- **8:52 The creator has conducted internal testing of the game's cards and found the results to be positive overall, with some balance issues to address.** (*Playtesting & metrics, high*)
 - The creator prepared six decks, each representing a different color, and tested them against each other. The results were positive, with each color having its moments of success. However, some balance issues were identified, such as the orange color being too slow and weak, and certain structures being too strong. The creator plans to fix these issues before sending the cards to playtesters.

- *For us:* The team should conduct internal testing of Dark Charterlands' cards to identify any balance issues before wider playtesting. Pay special attention to factions that might be underpowered or overpowered, and adjust their cards accordingly. Ensure that each faction has viable strategies and moments of success.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 18

Leandro · 1,539 views

Summary: The video provides an in-depth look into the development and updates of a trading card game, Multiverse, highlighting changes made to balance gameplay, introduce new mechanics, and incorporate player feedback. It also delves into the creative process behind new artwork and the iterative development of the game, with a focus on enhancing player interaction through instantaneous effects.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the importance of iterative development and player feedback in shaping the game's mechanics, balance, and overall player experience.

- **0:11 The power curve has been adjusted to encourage earlier gameplay and exploration.** (*Costing & balance, high*)
 - The previous power curve incentivized players to wait and stockpile resources, which the creator did not want. The new power curve is less steep, especially for higher-cost cards, to make it more worthwhile to play cards earlier in the game. For example, a card that cost seven resources under the old curve now costs six under the new curve, with a corresponding decrease in impact. The creator also adjusted the initial hand size from five to six cards, which changes the math and stats of the cards.
 - *For us:* The team should consider adjusting the power curve to encourage earlier gameplay and exploration. This could involve reducing the cost of higher-influence cards and increasing the initial hand size to make it more worthwhile to play cards earlier in the game. This will help to align with the 20-40 minute game length expectation.
- **8:47 The creator is making significant changes to card mechanics based on testing and feedback.** (*Playtesting & metrics, high*)
 - The creator has identified several issues with the current mechanics, such as the overpowered nature of cards that generate resources quickly and the underpowered nature of certain abilities. They are considering removing the speed stat and replacing it with an ability called 'flight' to address flavor issues and gameplay balance. Additionally, the creator is planning to replace the 'ambush' ability with 'quick shot' to make the mechanics cleaner and more intuitive.
 - *For us:* The team should be prepared to make significant changes to card mechanics based on testing and feedback. This includes addressing overpowered and underpowered abilities, and considering replacements for mechanics that are not working as intended. For example, they should test the balance of abilities like 'flight' and 'quick shot' to ensure they fit well within the game's mechanics.
- **15:46 The speaker is considering reintroducing instantaneous effects to the game Multiverse to enhance player interaction and gameplay dynamics.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker explains that instantaneous effects allow players to interact during their opponent's turn, adding tension and depth to the game. However, these effects were previously removed because they made the game too complex and slowed down gameplay. The speaker is now considering reintroducing them to see if they can improve the game without compromising its fun and fast-paced nature. The speaker has received positive feedback from playtesters, who have described the game as fun, which reassures the speaker that any changes made will be well-received.

- *For us:* The team should consider introducing instantaneous effects to enhance player interaction and gameplay dynamics. However, they should be mindful of the potential complexity and pacing issues that these effects might introduce, and ensure that any changes made do not compromise the fun and fast-paced nature of the game.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 19

Leandro · 1,459 views

Summary: The video provides an update on the development of the trading card game 'Multiverse', highlighting new website features, card art updates, and gameplay enhancements. It also delves into the testing and balancing of game mechanics, with a focus on quick actions and creature renaming, and shares insights from test sessions.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the significance of testing and balancing new mechanics to ensure they enhance gameplay without disrupting the desired pace, especially in a multiplayer format.

- **6:49 The speaker is testing new 'quick action' cards to add elements of surprise and bluffing to the game.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker introduces the concept of 'quick actions' which are instantaneous effects that can be played during the game. These actions are being tested to determine the best rules for their implementation without slowing down gameplay. Three different rule sets are proposed, each allowing quick actions to be played under different conditions, such as during an opponent's turn or in response to specific actions.
 - *For us:* The team should consider adding 'quick actions' to Dark Charterlands to introduce elements of surprise and bluffing. These should be designed to be instantaneous and tested thoroughly to ensure they do not slow down the game, especially in the multiplayer free-for-all format. The rules for when these actions can be played should be clear and balanced.
- **13:02 The game's quick actions need to be balanced to avoid slowing down gameplay.** (*Turn structure & pacing, high*)
 - The speaker notes that quick actions, initially designed to be used in specific situations, are not always useful and can slow down the game. They experimented with different rules for when quick actions can be played, finding that allowing them during any movement or attack in the galaxy works better for multiplayer games. The speaker also mentions that quick actions still need to be tested in multiplayer variants but are already adding depth to the gameplay without significantly slowing it down.
 - *For us:* The team should ensure that any new mechanics, like quick actions, are balanced to avoid slowing down gameplay. This is particularly important in Dark Charterlands, where games are expected to take 20-40 minutes. Testing these mechanics in the multiplayer free-for-all format is crucial to maintain the desired pace.
- **16:00 The term 'creatures' is being renamed to 'units' for clarity and consistency.** (*Onboarding & complexity, medium*)
 - The speaker decides to rename 'creatures' to 'units' to better encompass all types of game entities, including robots. This change is motivated by the realization that robots, while not living beings, function similarly to creatures in gameplay. The speaker also notes that the ability of robots to survive in outer space has never been a relevant factor in gameplay, making the distinction unnecessary.

- *For us:* The team should use clear and consistent terminology in Dark Charterlands. If there are entities that function similarly to units but are not traditionally considered 'units', consider renaming them for clarity. This will help reduce confusion for new players and streamline the learning process.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 20

Leandro · 1,091 views

Summary: The video highlights the development and upcoming community play-testing of a new trading card game, Multiverse Cosmic Conquest, including details on new art, website launch, and card set updates. It emphasizes the importance of community feedback and offers incentives for active participants.

Lesson for us: Organized play-testing and community feedback are crucial for balancing and refining the game, especially for a physical card game focused on booster drafts and multiplayer formats.

- **6:37 Significant changes have been made to the card set for 'Multiverse Cosmic Conquest'.** (*Draft & set structure, high*)
 - The speaker discusses the removal of uncommon colorless cards from the set, which were predominantly buildings. This change allows each color to have 10 uncommon cards instead of 9, which is important for limited gameplay and booster drafts. The speaker also mentions changes to void spaces, adding rules text to make them more useful in decks. Additionally, the speaker is considering a new community playtest session for the updated card set.
 - *For us:* Consider the distribution of uncommon cards and their impact on limited gameplay and booster drafts. Ensure that each faction has a balanced number of uncommon cards to maintain fairness and strategic depth in drafts.
- **11:39 A community play-testing session for Multiverse Cosmic Conquest is scheduled to start on March 14th and will run for 10 days.** (*Playtesting & metrics, high*)
 - The session is designed to test the new version of the base set. Participants are encouraged to sign up on the website and post their color choice in a thread. On March 14th, all participants will receive the cards and the rulebook. The session will focus on constructive play, and participants will build decks using the cards of one color. The speaker suggests that this play-testing session is crucial for the game's development, as it allows for organized feedback and discussion among participants.
 - *For us:* Plan organized play-testing sessions to gather constructive feedback. Focus on the new version of the base set and encourage participants to build decks using specific factions to test balance and strategy.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 21

Leandro · 1,600 views

Summary: The video explores the development process of a trading card game, Multiverse Cosmic Conquest, delving into the design and balancing of factions, unique card effects, and the importance of catering to diverse player types. The speaker also shares personal experiences with deck building, technical challenges, and the organization of playtest sessions, providing insights into the game's development and future events.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the need to balance and diversify gameplay mechanics and card effects to cater to various player types and ensure a rich, engaging experience.

- **0:20 The speaker has been refining the effects and strategies of each color in the trading card game to ensure balanced and diverse gameplay.** (*Costing & balance, high*)

- The speaker mentions that each color in the game has a distinct identity and philosophy. For example, blue represents knowledge and conquest through information, while orange relies on physical strength. The speaker has been tweaking the effects available to each color to ensure a wider range of possibilities and to avoid having colors with too many similar cards. This balancing act is crucial for maintaining a fair and engaging gameplay experience.
- *For us:* Ensure each faction in Dark Charterlands has a distinct identity and philosophy, with a wide range of abilities to avoid similar cards. This will help maintain balanced and diverse gameplay. Check that each faction's cards have unique effects that align with their identity.
- **3:44 The speaker has created detailed documents to organize and balance the effects and strategies of different colors.** (*Costing & balance, high*)
 - To help organize the effects and strategies of different colors, the speaker created a document outlining all the abilities and general strategies related to color combinations. Additionally, a more detailed document breaks down specific effects that cards can have and how they fit into the colors. These documents are essential for ensuring that each color has a diverse set of skills and that the game remains balanced.
 - *For us:* Create detailed documents outlining the abilities and strategies for each faction and their combinations. This will help in organizing and balancing the effects and strategies of different factions in Dark Charterlands.
- **9:30 The speaker discusses the importance of considering different player types and playstyles when designing a trading card game.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker emphasizes the need to consider different player types and playstyles when designing a trading card game. This includes players who enjoy big, splashy effects, tournament players who focus on the metagame, and players who like to experiment. The speaker suggests that a well-designed game should cater to all these types of players to ensure a diverse and engaging player base.
 - *For us:* Design Dark Charterlands with various player types in mind, including those who enjoy big effects, tournament players, and experimental players. This will ensure a diverse and engaging player base.
- **12:28 The speaker discusses the enjoyment and challenges of deck building in trading card games, emphasizing the fun of creating unique and wacky decks.** (*Draft & set structure, medium*)
 - The speaker highlights that having cards in a game that inspire players to build around them can be very enjoyable. They mention that even if a deck isn't particularly effective, the experience of playing with it can be rewarding. The speaker admits to building wacky decks themselves, noting that these decks are fun to play because they are unpredictable and challenging for opponents.
 - *For us:* Include cards in Dark Charterlands that inspire unique and wacky deck-building experiences. This will add fun and unpredictability to the game, even if some decks are not highly effective.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 22

Leandro · 1,366 views

Summary: The video explores the development process of a trading card game, Multiverse, focusing on playtesting challenges, gameplay mechanics, and design decisions. It also covers plans for a Kickstarter campaign to fund both physical and digital versions of the game.

Lesson for us: Streamline mechanics and consider player experience to enhance gameplay and accessibility.

- **4:30 The boarding mechanic in the game needs to be adjusted to improve gameplay.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)

- The speaker discusses the boarding mechanic, which was initially an ability of all units but is being changed to a keyword ability. This change will make the game more streamlined and reduce unnecessary complexity. The speaker also notes that boarding should be a property of ships rather than units, which aligns better with the game's space theme and adds diversity to ships.
- *For us:* Review the mechanics of the game to ensure that abilities are streamlined and do not add unnecessary complexity. Consider if any abilities in Dark Charterlands could be keyworded or simplified to improve gameplay.
- **15:10 The speaker decides to remove activated abilities from the current set of cards.** (*Onboarding & complexity, medium*)
 - Activated abilities are those that can be activated by paying a certain cost. The speaker found that these abilities did not add much to the gameplay and were often extra fluff on the cards. Removing them will streamline the gameplay and provide a slightly easier entrance point for new players.
 - *For us:* Consider removing or simplifying activated abilities in Dark Charterlands to make the game more accessible for new players. Ensure that the game's mechanics are intuitive and do not overwhelm beginners.
- **17:46 The speaker introduces the concept of 'reactions' to add tension to gameplay.** (*Card & mechanic design, high*)
 - Reactions can be played on your turn and in response to specific events, such as an attack being declared or an opponent moving a unit onto your space. This adds a surprise factor to battles and keeps both players more alert during the opponent's turn. The speaker is still evaluating how this will work in multiplayer.
 - *For us:* Introduce 'reactions' in Dark Charterlands to add tension and surprise to gameplay. Ensure that these reactions are balanced and do not disrupt the flow of the game, especially in multiplayer settings.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game 23: Launch of the Multiverse Online Beta!

Leandro · 842 views

Summary: The video is an announcement and promotional piece for the upcoming game 'Multiverse Cosmic Congress', highlighting the launch of its online beta, a virtual tabletop simulator, and significant gameplay updates. The speaker emphasizes the potential of the game and encourages viewers to support an upcoming Kickstarter campaign and stay tuned for further developments.

Lesson for us: Adapting abilities to add depth and strategic choices can enhance gameplay, so consider how similar mechanics can be integrated into Dark Charterlands.

- **1:20 Significant gameplay changes have been made, including updates to cargo and shield abilities.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker highlights two major changes to the game: the cargo and shield abilities. Cargo is now scalable, allowing ships and units to carry varying amounts of resources, which adds depth to gameplay. Shields have also been updated to provide constant protection against damage, preventing the first X damage dealt to the object each turn. These changes aim to enhance the strategic and interactive aspects of the game.
 - *For us:* Consider how abilities like cargo and shields can be adapted to Dark Charterlands to add depth to gameplay. For example, units with scalable cargo abilities could carry varying amounts of *Seals* (the resource), and shields could protect units from the first X damage each turn, enhancing strategic decisions.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game 24: Complexity in TCGs

Leandro · 1,047 views

Summary: The video explores strategies to make trading card games more accessible to new players, focusing on the game Multiverse Cosmic Conquest. The speaker, Leandro, discusses various methods to simplify the learning process, such as tutorials and preconstructed decks, while also providing updates on the game's development and the challenges of balancing simplicity and complexity in game design.

Lesson for us: To make Dark Charterlands more accessible, the team should focus on simplifying the onboarding process through tutorials, preconstructed decks, and a base set with simpler cards, while ensuring the game remains strategically deep.

- **6:29 The speaker discusses the complexity inherent in trading card games (TCGs) and the challenges it poses for new players.** (*Onboarding & complexity, medium*)
 - The speaker explains that TCGs are generally complex due to their rules and the vast number of choices in deck building. This complexity creates a barrier for new players who may not understand the genre or the rules. The speaker suggests that new players often learn the game through explanations from experienced players, but this is not always reliable, especially for new games where all players are new. The speaker also mentions that some TCGs use base sets with simpler cards to help new players, but this does not eliminate the complexity of deck building.
 - *For us:* Dark Charterlands should consider creating a base set with simpler cards to help new players understand the game mechanics. Additionally, providing clear and concise rules explanations and tutorials can lower the barrier to entry.
- **9:50 The speaker outlines various strategies to reduce the complexity and barrier of entry for new players in TCGs.** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)
 - The speaker discusses several methods to make TCGs more accessible to new players. These include using base sets with simpler cards, creating preconstructed decks that are easy to understand, and dividing the game into different modes with varying levels of complexity. The speaker also mentions that online TCGs can utilize in-game tutorials to teach players the basics of the game. Additionally, the speaker suggests that having a friend explain the rules is still one of the best ways to learn a TCG.
 - *For us:* The team should design preconstructed decks for Dark Charterlands that are easy to understand and use. These decks can serve as a starting point for new players and help them grasp the fundamentals of the game. Additionally, dividing the game into different modes with varying levels of complexity can cater to both new and experienced players.
- **12:36 The speaker suggests several strategies to lower the complexity barrier for new players in trading card games.** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)
 - The speaker suggests using tutorials, preconstructed decks, and simplifying common cards to make the game more accessible. The speaker also mentions the importance of balancing the complexity of rules and cards to ensure the game remains interesting and manageable. The speaker highlights that Multiverse Cosmic Conquest will include a tutorial in the online version of the game, which will walk new players through their first few games with a preconstructed deck.
 - *For us:* Incorporating tutorials and preconstructed decks into Dark Charterlands can significantly enhance the onboarding experience for new players. Simplifying common cards can also make the game more accessible without compromising its depth.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game 25: Finding the right platform

Leandro · 667 views

Summary: The video discusses the process of designing a platform for an online trading card game, focusing on the specific needs and challenges of such a game compared to other types of online games. The speaker explains the necessity of creating a custom platform tailored to the unique requirements of a trading card game, rather than adapting existing solutions designed for more graphically intensive games.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson for the team is to focus on creating a clear and intuitive user interface for the physical components of the game, ensuring that players can easily understand and navigate the game.

- **2:19 The speaker describes the high-level design considerations for the trading card game platform.** (*Business & distribution, low*)
 - The speaker outlines the key components of the client-side design, including a deck builder, card collection manager, lobby for viewing and joining games, and a store for purchasing game items. The high-level design also considers the server setup, including the need for separate servers for each game to minimize costs and optimize performance. The speaker emphasizes the importance of learning about different platforms and engines to find the best fit for the game's requirements.
 - *For us:* The team should focus on creating a clear and intuitive user interface for the physical components, such as the deck builder and card collection manager, to ensure that players can easily understand and navigate the game. Since the game is physical, the design should prioritize ease of use and accessibility.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 26 - Kickstarter Launch, Multiplayer & Card Wordings

Leandro · 907 views

Summary: The video explores the development and launch of a Kickstarter campaign for the trading card game 'Multiverse: Cosmic Conquest', highlighting innovative multiplayer features and the importance of balancing gameplay. It also delves into the iterative process of refining card effects and terminology to enhance clarity and player experience.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the critical need for clear, unambiguous card wording and intuitive terminology to enhance player understanding and engagement, especially in a complex, multiplayer trading card game.

- **1:11 The game's rules and card wordings have been updated to improve clarity and balance.** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)
 - The speaker mentions that the game's rules have been updated, and the card wordings have been revised for better clarity. This includes fixing 'weird wonky wording' and ensuring that the rules are clear and understandable for players. The updates aim to enhance the overall gameplay experience by making the rules and card effects more intuitive.
 - *For us:* Regularly update and refine the game's rules and card wordings to improve clarity. This will help new players understand the game more quickly and reduce confusion.
- **1:31 The game includes multiplayer features with instant actions to enhance interaction and reduce wait times.** (*Multiplayer & politics, high*)
 - The speaker explains that multiplayer games in 'Multiverse: Cosmic Conquest' can be longer due to more players and turn-based mechanics. To mitigate this, they introduced 'instant actions' that allow players to respond to actions directly affecting them, reducing overall wait times and increasing interaction. This design ensures that players remain engaged even when it's not their turn.

- *For us:* Introduce 'instant actions' to allow players to respond to actions directly affecting them, reducing wait times and increasing interaction. This is especially important in multiplayer games where turn-based mechanics can lead to longer game durations.
- **8:23 The 'wormhole' card is introduced to make multiplayer games more dynamic and engaging.** (*Multiplayer & politics, medium*)
 - The speaker introduces the 'wormhole' card, a galaxy card that allows objects to move from one wormhole to another, effectively shortening the distance between different parts of the galaxy. This card is designed to be more powerful in multiplayer games, enhancing interaction and dynamics without affecting the balance of two-player games. The wormhole card requires at least two wormholes to be explored for movement, ensuring it doesn't become overpowered.
 - *For us:* Design cards like the 'wormhole' card to enhance interaction and dynamics in multiplayer games. Ensure these cards are balanced and do not overpower two-player games.
- **12:19 The speaker discusses the importance of clear and unambiguous card wording in a trading card game.** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)
 - The speaker explains that the initial wording of a card effect was misinterpreted by playtesters, leading to confusion. The card's effect involved moving objects through wormholes, but players misunderstood the range and movement mechanics. To address this, the speaker worked on revising the card's wording to make it more intuitive and self-explanatory. The speaker also mentions the challenge of fitting the text within the limited space on the card. The final wording was simplified to ensure it could only be interpreted in one way, aligning with the game's rules.
 - *For us:* Ensure card wording is clear and unambiguous to avoid misinterpretation. This may involve revising wording multiple times based on playtesting feedback. Consider the limited space on the card and aim for simplicity.
- **16:05 The speaker describes changes made to the terminology used on cards to improve readability.** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)
 - The speaker highlights that the original terminology on some cards was confusing and not intuitive. For example, the effect of the Galactic Alliance card was initially written as 'gained control of all planets under no players control,' which was deemed too complex. The speaker changed the terminology to use more straightforward terms like 'allied' for friendly units, 'enemy' for opponent's units, and 'neutral' for unexplored spaces. This change made the card effects easier to understand without altering the underlying rules.
 - *For us:* Use intuitive and straightforward terminology on cards to improve readability. Avoid complex phrases and opt for simple terms that convey the same meaning.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 27 - Card Art Creation Process & Card Front Design

Leandro · 4,584 views

Summary: The video explores the intricate process of designing artwork and layouts for a trading card game, emphasizing the collaborative efforts between creators and illustrators, and the importance of clear, intuitive design for an enhanced user experience. It delves into the detailed description and iterative refinement of each card, as well as the strategic placement of text, cost, and stats boxes on the card front.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the importance of clear, intuitive design for an enhanced user experience, which will help new players understand the game and make informed decisions.

- **1:34 The video describes the detailed description process for each card, which includes specifying the color scheme, environment, focus, and ability of the card.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - Leandro provides a detailed description for each card, which includes the color scheme, environment, focus, and ability of the card. For example, the description for the Spice Smuggler card includes details about the ship, the smuggler's actions, and the effect of the card. This description is translated into English for the video but is normally written in Russian for the illustrators. The color scheme is important because the front of the card becomes a frame for the artwork, and there are seven different variations of the front of the card. The environment is described in detail, including the background and any relevant objects. The focus of the card is the main subject, in this case, the human smuggler, and the description includes details about the smuggler's actions and the effect of the card.
 - *For us:* Ensure that the descriptions for each card in Dark Charterlands are detailed and clear, including color schemes, environments, and the focus of the card. This will help illustrators create artwork that accurately reflects the card's abilities and types, making it easier for new players to understand the game.
- **5:18 The video outlines the iterative process of refining the artwork, involving initial sketches, working progress, and final illustrations.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The process of creating the artwork involves several stages. Initially, the illustrator creates one or more sketches based on the description provided. These sketches are reviewed, and feedback is given. For example, Max Palchikov's initial sketch for the Spice Smuggler card is reviewed, and suggestions are made to improve the composition and the positioning of the hand. The illustrator then creates a working progress image, which is discussed further. In this stage, specific issues, such as the positioning of the hand, are addressed. The final illustration is created after incorporating all the feedback and making necessary adjustments.
 - *For us:* Establish a clear iterative process for refining artwork in Dark Charterlands, involving initial sketches, working progress, and final illustrations. This will ensure that the artwork is of high quality and accurately represents the card's abilities and types.
- **10:09 The video explains the design of the card front, including the layout of text and visual elements, and the creation of different color variations.** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)
 - The design of the card front involves arranging various text and visual elements. The name of the card is placed at the top, followed by the type line, which includes the type and subtypes of the card. The text box contains all the effects and flavor text of the card. The cost and stats are placed below the text box. The rarity and additional information, such as copyright and illustrator credits, are placed at the bottom. The creator designed the card front to be clean and easy to read, with the image of the card's subject prominently displayed. To create different color variations, the creator used a base design and switched out the background color for each variation.
 - *For us:* Design the card front in Dark Charterlands to be clean and easy to read, with the image of the card's subject prominently displayed. Arrange text and visual elements in a logical order, with the name of the card at the top, followed by the type line, text box, cost and stats, and additional information at the bottom.
- **13:49 The speaker designed the card layout to clearly display cost and stats, using separate symbols for each resource to avoid confusion.** (*Onboarding & complexity, high*)

- The speaker explains that the card layout is designed to clearly show the cost and stats of each card. Separate symbols are used for each resource to avoid confusion, especially for those unfamiliar with the game. The cost symbols are positioned based on the card's cost, with higher costs moving to the bottom row. The stack box is removable for action cards that do not have stats. The speaker also mentions that the design allows for cards with costs up to 12 resources, although no cards currently cost 12.
- *For us:* Use separate symbols for each resource in Dark Charterlands to avoid confusion, especially for those unfamiliar with the game. Design the card layout to clearly show the cost and stats of each card, with higher costs moving to the bottom row. Ensure that the design allows for cards with costs up to 12 resources, although no cards currently cost 12.

Let's Make a Trading Card Game: 28 - Kickstarter Lessons Learned & New Card Front

Leandro · 1,305 views

Summary: The video explores the journey of developing a trading card game, initially titled 'Multiverse Cosmic Conquest', from its failed Kickstarter campaign to its redesign as a living card game. The creator discusses the lessons learned from the campaign's failures, the iterative design process of the card layout, and the adjustments made to the game's structure and content. The video also touches on future plans for the game and the creator's personal career developments.

Lesson for us: The most important lesson from this video is the value of learning from failure and iterating on design based on real-world feedback and constraints, particularly in areas like card layout, costing, and balance.

- **4:29 The lack of a physical prototype and the hybrid nature of the game made it difficult to get coverage from reviewers.** (*Business & distribution, medium*)
 - Tabletop reviewers preferred physical prototypes, which the team did not have, while video game reviewers expected a demo with features like AI and tutorials. The game's online version, though playable, did not meet these expectations, leading to a lack of positive dialogue with reviewers. Additionally, board game reviewers generally dislike trading card games due to their ongoing purchase model, further limiting coverage.
 - *For us:* Ensure that Dark Charterlands has a physical prototype ready for reviewers. Consider creating a simple, engaging tutorial or quick-start guide to help reviewers understand the game's unique mechanics, such as the multiplayer free-for-all format and the use of Seals as a resource.
- **7:37 The team decided to pivot to a living card game format due to financial constraints and market realities.** (*Business & distribution, medium*)
 - The online version of the game was deemed unfeasible due to lack of funds. The team realized that smaller, independent trading card games struggle in the market dominated by giants like Magic: The Gathering and Pokémon. Therefore, they decided to release 'Multiverse Cosmic Conquest' as a living card game, which is sold in a single box with all cards included, making it easier to produce and distribute.
 - *For us:* Be prepared for potential resistance from board game reviewers who may dislike trading card games. Highlight the unique aspects of Dark Charterlands, such as the multiplayer free-for-all format and the Community Charters system, to generate interest.
- **12:07 The design of the card front was redesigned to address printing issues and maximize space.** (*Card & mechanic design, high*)

- The initial design had issues with color frames causing cutting inaccuracies and a font that was too large. The team experimented with shrinking text and stats, adding a black border to mitigate cutting errors, and adjusting the layout to maximize the image size while maintaining text space. This redesign aimed to create a more visually appealing and functional card front.
 - *For us:* Consider the financial constraints and market realities when designing Dark Charterlands. Ensure that the game's pricing and distribution model is feasible for a smaller, independent trading card game.
- **13:42 The speaker iteratively redesigned the card layout to maximize image space and improve visual appeal.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker began by stretching the image to fit a square frame, aiming to make the card more visually pleasing. They experimented with different layouts, removing unnecessary lines and adjusting the placement of text and other elements to reduce clutter. The final design featured a larger, more square image area, with text and other information rearranged for better readability and aesthetic appeal. The speaker also discussed the challenges of integrating new designs with existing artwork and the decision to proceed with the new format despite some cards not fitting perfectly.
 - *For us:* Ensure that the card layout for Dark Charterlands is visually appealing and functional. Consider the placement of text, images, and other elements to maximize readability and aesthetic appeal.
- **15:31 The speaker encountered and resolved several design issues, such as color problems and text placement.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - During the design process, the speaker noticed that the colors in the new layout were muddy and not as vibrant as intended. They adjusted the opacity of certain layers to fix this issue. Additionally, the speaker addressed the problem of text being too close to the edge of the card, which looked unappealing. They centered the text better and ensured there was adequate space around it.
 - *For us:* Pay close attention to the printing process for Dark Charterlands. Ensure that the colors are vibrant and that the text is well-placed and easy to read.
- **20:12 The speaker discussed the challenges of integrating new designs with existing artwork.** (*Card & mechanic design, medium*)
 - The speaker mentioned that many images were already drawn to fit the old format, and the new square-like format would require redrawing or cutting parts of the images. They consulted with illustrators, and despite some cards not fitting perfectly with the new format, they decided to proceed with the change because it looked better overall. The speaker also showed examples of new illustrations that fit the updated format.
 - *For us:* Be prepared for potential challenges when integrating new designs with existing artwork. Consult with illustrators to ensure that the artwork fits well with the new format, and be willing to make adjustments as needed.
- **25:26 The speaker learned valuable lessons from the printing experience.** (*Business & distribution, medium*)
 - The speaker reflected on the printing experience, noting that failure can be a good teacher. They learned about issues like color bleeding and text placement, which informed their design decisions. The speaker also mentioned that the new Star Wars movie emphasizes the value of learning from failure, which resonated with their own experience.
 - *For us:* Learn from the printing experience and use it to inform design decisions. Pay close attention to issues like color bleeding and text placement, and be willing to make adjustments as needed.
- **25:41 The speaker decided to transition the game from a trading card format to a living card game format.** (*Draft & set structure, high*)

- The speaker explains that the transition involves more than just a name change; it affects the entire card set. The new format will not include rarities, and each card will be designed as an equal part of the set rather than in relation to draft or limited environments. This change allows for more complex cards to replace certain commons, making the entire set more cohesive. The speaker also mentions the removal of colorless cards, which were primarily used for draft and sealed purposes.
- *For us:* Consider the implications of the game's format on card design and balance. Ensure that the cards are designed to work well together in the multiplayer free-for-all format, and that the game's balance is not overly reliant on rarities or draft environments.
- **29:10 The speaker is making changes to the card game Multiverse, including adjusting the number of cards per color and adding a new rare card.** (*Draft & set structure, medium*)
 - The speaker explains that they are removing six cards from the game, which will result in each color having 31 cards instead of 30. This change allows for the addition of a new rare card. The speaker also mentions that there are other mathematical changes but will explain them in a different video. The speaker suggests that Multiverse is evolving into a living card game.
 - *For us:* Be prepared to make adjustments to the card set as needed. Consider the implications of adding or removing cards on the game's balance and overall design.